

THE MAIDS OF VIRGINIA

August 2026 Instagram Content Plan | @themaids of virginia | Referred for a reason.

GOAL: FOLLOWER GROWTH + ENGAGEMENT — NOT SALES

13 FEED POSTS

21 STORY DAYS

WEEKDAYS ONLY

August 2026 Calendar

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
					1 rest	2 rest
3 POST: B/A Reel The Grout Comeback Story: poll > B/A	4 Story only Review graphic Yes/No > Reviews	5 POST: Maid Simple #1 Stainless steel (kept) Story: Yes/No > Service	6 Story only Question box: ask a pro > Service	7 POST: Suds and Science #1 Bleach + vinegar (VO 1) Story: Yes/No > Service	8 rest	9 rest
10 POST: B/A Reel Kitchen, 22-Step captions Story: poll > B/A	11 Story only Review graphic Poll > Reviews	12 POST: Maid Simple #2 Dust top to bottom Story: question > Service	13 Story only Q+A answer round > Service	14 POST: Testimonial Reel Jeff E., 5 stars Story: poll > Reviews	15 rest	16 rest
17 POST: B/A Reel Upholstery rescue Story: slider > B/A	18 Story only Review graphic Yes/No > Reviews	19 POST: Maid Simple #3 Two-towel rule Story: Yes/No > Service	20 Story only Team BTS + guess poll > Our Team	21 POST: Suds and Science #2 Bleach + glass cleaner Story: poll > Service	22 rest	23 rest
24 POST: B/A Reel The Oven Finale Story: poll > B/A	25 Story only Review graphic Slider > Reviews	26 POST: Maid Simple #4 Dwell time (VO 2) Story: question > Service	27 Story only Spotlight teaser poll > Our Team	28 POST: Team Spotlight Day-in-the-life montage Story: slider > Our Team	29 rest	30 rest
31 POST: B/A Reel The September Reset Story: poll > B/A						

Monday — Before/After Reel

Wednesday — Maid Simple Reel

Friday — rotating slot

Tue/Thu — Story only

VO = one of the month's two voiceover Reels (Aug 7 and Aug 26). Every other Reel is trending audio or ASMR cleaning sound with text overlay. Saturdays and Sundays are fully off: no posts, no Stories.

Standard Hashtag Block — defined once, used everywhere

Paste as the **first comment** on every feed post (never in the caption), within one minute of publishing:

#TheMaidsOfVirginia #ReferredForAREason #maidservice #cleaningservice #housecleaning
#residentialcleaning #deepcleaning #professionalcleaners #cleaningtips #cleaninghacks #cleantok
#satisfyingcleaning #asmrcleaning #beforeandafter #cleaningmotivation #alexandriava #arlingtonva
#washingtondc #princewilliamcounty #manassas #northernva

21 tags: brand + the stated service area (Alexandria, Arlington, D.C., Prince William) + reach-focused cleaning tags. In the post blocks below, "First comment" always means this exact block.

Operating Rules for the Month

Posting structure (weekdays only)

- **Monday** — Before/After transformation Reel. Under 15 seconds, dirty shot first, hold the after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover applied before posting.
- **Wednesday** — Maid Simple tip Reel. Pro-level tips only: things a professional cleaner knows that most homeowners do not.
- **Friday** — rotating slot: Suds and Science (Aug 7) > Testimonial, saved to the Reviews highlight (Aug 14) > Suds and Science (Aug 21) > Team Spotlight (Aug 28).
- No Saturday or Sunday posts or Stories of any kind. Suggested publish window: 11:30 am–1:00 pm ET.
- Every Reel gets a branded cover before posting (Sapphire Blue bar, series name in Golden Yellow) so the grid reads as three clean, recognizable series.

Audio and voice rules

- No one speaks on camera, ever, in any language. No talking-head content, no spoken tips.
- Default sound: a trending audio chosen the week of posting, or ASMR cleaning sound, always with text overlay.
- **Exactly two Reels this month use a recorded voiceover:** Aug 7 (Suds and Science #1) and Aug 26 (Maid Simple #4). Short scripts are included in those post blocks. No other Reel uses voiceover.
- Written voice: professional, authoritative, reassuring, efficient.
- The mess is never the client's fault — it is the opponent the team beats. No shame language toward clients, ever.
- Keep every chemical claim accurate and specific. Never exaggerate.

Engagement-first defaults (account is under 100 followers)

- Share every post to Stories the day it publishes with an interactive sticker: poll, slider, Yes/No, or question box. Engagement stickers are the priority at this size.
- Save every Story to one of four highlights: **Reviews, Our Team, Before/After, Service**. By September 1 all four highlights are fully populated from this rhythm alone.
- Every caption ends with a follow, save, share, or comment prompt. No booking CTAs this month — the goal is reach and community, not sales.
- Reply to every comment and question-sticker answer within 24 hours; at this follower count, each reply roughly doubles that person's odds of following.

Weekly Story Rhythm (repeats all month, Monday–Friday)

Day	Story	Interactive sticker	Save to highlight
Mon	Share the Before/After Reel	Poll	Before/After
Tue	Review graphic (brand template: sapphire background, golden stars, white quote)	Yes/No, poll, or slider	Reviews
Wed	Share the Maid Simple Reel	Yes/No or question box	Service
Thu	Engagement day: question box, answer round, or team behind-the-scenes	Question box or poll	Service / Our Team
Fri	Share the Friday post	Poll, slider, or Yes/No	Matches the slot: Reviews, Service, or Our Team
Sat–Sun	Off. No posts, no Stories.	—	—

What Changed From the Prior Version

Seven changes, at a glance

- Educational series name locked as **Suds and Science** (was “Don't Mix That!”). Aug 7 and Aug 21 keep their accurate chemistry topics under the new name.
- Aug 3 concept fully replaced — the “Yohanna vs. hardwater” footage was not used. New bathroom transformation (“The Grout Comeback”) with a new hook.

- Aug 26 “vacuum before you mop” tip replaced entirely with a pro-level dwell-time tip. Aug 5 stainless steel tip kept as-is.
- All weekend activity removed — posts and Stories run Monday–Friday only — and the Saturday neighborhood/service-area Story is gone. Highlights consolidate to Reviews, Our Team, Before/After, Service.
- Spanish spoken-tip option removed under the new audio rules — no one speaks on camera in any language. All Reels are music or ASMR plus text overlay except the two marked voiceover Reels (Aug 7, Aug 26).
- Every Story now carries an interactive sticker; Thursdays become dedicated engagement days (Q+A, answer rounds, team behind-the-scenes).
- Hashtag block rebuilt around the stated service area plus reach-focused cleaning tags.

Post-by-Post Details

Every post and story day of the month, in order. Captions are paste-ready. “First comment” always means the standard hashtag block defined on page 1.

MON AUG 3 BEFORE/AFTER REEL — THE GROUT COMEBACK	
FORMAT	Reel, under 15 seconds. Dirty shot first, hold the after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover applied before posting.
AUDIO	ASMR brush-and-foam sound or trending audio, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“The grout was white the whole time.”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Bathroom tile, grout, and tub. 0–2 sec: tight shot of dulled grout lines and a filmed tub edge. 2–13 sec: fast ASMR montage — grout brush, foam, rinse. Final beat: wide shot of bright tile, held 2 full seconds. Real footage, no filter on the after.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Soap scum and mineral film build up in every busy bathroom — that is not neglect, that is chemistry doing what chemistry does. Our team met it with the 22-Step Healthy Touch Deep Cleaning System and won. Watch the last frame: real grout, no filter. Which reveal should we film next — tile, tub, or glass? Tell us below. Alexandria, Arlington, D.C. and Prince William. Follow for a transformation every Monday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: “Be honest — did you think that grout was beige?” Yes / 100%. Save to the Before/After highlight.
NOTES	Replaces the prior “Yohanna vs. hardwater” concept — that footage was not used.
TUE AUG 4 STORY ONLY — REVIEW GRAPHIC #1	
Brand-template review graphic (sapphire background, golden five stars, white quote text) featuring a recent 5-star review. Sticker: Yes/No — “Have you ever hired a professional cleaning team?” Save to the Reviews highlight.	

WED AUG 5 | MAID SIMPLE #1 — STAINLESS STEEL (KEPT AS-IS)

FORMAT	Reel, about 10 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	ASMR spray-and-wipe audio with text overlay. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Maid Simple: streak-free stainless in 10 seconds”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Close-up demo on a fridge or dishwasher front: microfiber cloth glides, paper towel comparison flashes briefly, finish on the streak-free panel.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Maid Simple, tip #1: microfiber, not paper towels, on stainless steel. Zero streaks, zero lint. Save this for Sunday reset. Follow for a new pro tip every Wednesday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a Yes/No sticker: “Did you know this?” Save to the Service highlight.
NOTES	Carried over unchanged from the prior plan, except the spoken-Spanish option is dropped under the new audio rules.

THU AUG 6 | STORY ONLY — QUESTION BOX

One clean branded frame: “Ask a professional house cleaner anything.” Question box sticker. Prompt ideas on the frame: stubborn surfaces, product choices, room order. Answers feed next Thursday’s story. Save to the **Service** highlight.

FRI AUG 7 | SUDS AND SCIENCE #1 — BLEACH + VINEGAR (VOICEOVER REEL 1 OF 2)

FORMAT	Reel, 15–20 seconds. Series visual: two bottles side by side, big red X between them, bold text overlay. Branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Voiceover Reel 1 of 2 (calm, professional narration recorded off-camera) over soft music. Script: “Two bottles you probably own. Bleach and vinegar each clean beautifully — mixed together, they release chlorine gas. Different days, different buckets, always. Suds and Science, from The Maids of Virginia.”
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“These two are under your sink right now. Never combine them.”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Text-forward safety explainer. Bottles labeled BLEACH and VINEGAR slide in, red X lands between them, key line appears: “bleach + vinegar = chlorine gas.” This is a save-and-share magnet.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Suds and Science, part 1. Bleach plus vinegar releases chlorine gas, which can irritate your eyes, throat, and lungs even in small amounts. Use them on different days, in different buckets, always. Our teams are trained on safe product handling in every home. Save this one and share it with anyone who mixes their own cleaners. Follow for more Suds and Science.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a Yes/No sticker: “Did you know this combination was dangerous?” Save to the Service highlight.
NOTES	Chemistry stays accurate and specific — chlorine gas is an irritant even at low levels; do not exaggerate beyond the caption language.

MON AUG 10 | BEFORE/AFTER REEL — KITCHEN, 22-STEP BRANDING

FORMAT	Reel, under 15 seconds. Dirty shot first, hold the after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Trending audio or ASMR kitchen sounds, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Step 14 of 22: appliance exteriors” — rotate numbered step captions through the clip.</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Time-lapse of a full kitchen clean compressed under 15 seconds: greasy stovetop first, then counters, sink, appliance fronts, with 22-Step captions rotating on screen. The numbered system is the differentiator no competitor can copy. Final wide shot held 2 seconds.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Grease never quits — neither does the checklist. This kitchen got the full 22-Step Healthy Touch Deep Cleaning System: every step, every visit, in the same order every time. Save this if you love a system. Alexandria, Arlington, D.C. and Prince William. Follow along — Mondays are for transformations.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: “Toughest kitchen opponent?” Stovetop / Microwave / Sink. Save to the Before/After highlight.

TUE AUG 11 | STORY ONLY — REVIEW GRAPHIC #2

Brand-template review graphic, different review than Aug 4. Sticker: poll — “What matters most in a cleaning team?” Consistency / Attention to detail. Save to the **Reviews** highlight.

WED AUG 12 | MAID SIMPLE #2 — DUST TOP TO BOTTOM

FORMAT	Reel, 10–15 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Trending audio or ASMR dusting sound, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Maid Simple: why we always start at the ceiling”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Quick clips in strict order: ceiling fan, shelf, baseboard, vacuum. An arrow overlay drops down the frame with each cut to make the gravity logic visible.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Maid Simple, tip #2: dust falls. Start with fans and shelves, finish with floors, and you only clean everything once. Save this order for your next whole-room clean. Follow for a new pro tip every Wednesday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a question sticker: “What do you always forget to dust?” Screenshot the best answers for Thursday’s answer round. Save to the Service highlight.

THU AUG 13 | STORY ONLY — ANSWER ROUND

Two or three branded frames answering the best questions from the Aug 6 question box and the Aug 12 question sticker (credit askers by first name only). Last frame: Yes/No — “Want more Q+A Thursdays?” Save to the **Service** highlight.

FRI AUG 14 | TESTIMONIAL REEL — JEFF E.

FORMAT	Reel, 10–15 seconds, branded cover before posting. Saved to the Reviews highlight via the story share.
AUDIO	Soft trending audio, no dialogue. Five golden stars animate in over real footage of the team working.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>Five stars animating in over footage of the actual team at work.</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Pair the named quote with footage of the team that cleaned that home: arrival, detail shots, the finished rooms. Quote appears line by line in white on sapphire.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	“Like always, they exceed every expectation.” Thank you, Jeff E. Referred for a reason — and this is the reason. Follow to meet the teams behind the reviews.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: “Best part of a freshly cleaned home?” Walking in the door / The smell / Not lifting a finger / The first shower. Save to the Reviews highlight.

MON AUG 17 | BEFORE/AFTER REEL — UPHOLSTERY RESCUE

FORMAT	Reel, under 15 seconds. Dirty shot first, hold the after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	ASMR extraction sound (very satisfying) or trending audio, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“That couch was gray. It is actually purple.”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Dull, dusty cushion close-up first, extraction pass in real time, wipe transition to the true color, wide after shot held 2 full seconds.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Sofas collect more than crumbs — dust and fibers settle in and mute the color one shade at a time. One deep pass and the whole room wakes up. Share this with someone who loves a good reveal. Alexandria, Arlington, D.C. and Prince William. Follow for Monday transformations.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a slider sticker: “How satisfying was this?” Save to the Before/After highlight.

TUE AUG 18 | STORY ONLY — REVIEW GRAPHIC #3

Brand-template review graphic, new review. Sticker: Yes/No — “Do you read reviews before trying a local business?” Save to the **Reviews** highlight.

WED AUG 19 | MAID SIMPLE #3 — THE TWO-TOWEL RULE

FORMAT	Reel, about 10 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	ASMR glass-squeak sound or trending audio, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Maid Simple: the two-towel rule for glass and mirrors”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	10-second mirror demo: damp microfiber cleans, dry microfiber buffs, camera catches the zero-streak finish at an angle in raking light.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Maid Simple, tip #3: one damp microfiber to clean, one dry to buff. That second towel is the whole secret — it lifts the residue the first towel loosens, so nothing dries into a streak. Save this for your next mirror. Follow for a new pro tip every Wednesday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a Yes/No sticker: “Did you know the second-towel trick?” Save to the Service highlight.

THU AUG 20 | STORY ONLY — TEAM BEHIND-THE-SCENES

Photo of a four-person team's morning load-out: labeled caddies, color-coded microfiber, HEPA vacuum. Sticker: poll — “Guess: how many microfiber cloths does one team go through in a day?” 10 / 25 / 50+. Reveal the real number in a second frame. Save to the **Our Team** highlight.

FRI AUG 21 | SUDS AND SCIENCE #2 — BLEACH + GLASS CLEANER

FORMAT	Reel or text-forward post, 15–20 seconds. Same visual system as part 1 (bottles, red X) so the series is instantly recognizable in the grid. Branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Trending audio or soft music with text overlay. No dialogue, no voiceover — the month's two voiceover slots are Aug 7 and Aug 26.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Bleach and glass cleaner do not belong in the same bucket.”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Part 2 of the series: bottle labeled GLASS CLEANER slides in beside BLEACH, red X lands, key line appears: “ammonia + bleach = chloramine fumes.”
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Suds and Science, part 2. Many glass cleaners contain ammonia, and ammonia plus bleach creates chloramine fumes that can leave you dizzy, short of breath, and sick. One product at a time, with the fan on. It is one reason professional teams carry separate, labeled supplies for every job. Save it, share it. Follow for more Suds and Science.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: “Which combination surprised you more?” Bleach + vinegar / Bleach + glass cleaner. Save to the Service highlight.

MON AUG 24 | BEFORE/AFTER REEL — THE OVEN FINALE

FORMAT	Reel, under 15 seconds. Dirty shot first, hold the after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	ASMR scrub-and-foam sound or trending audio, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>"The inside of the oven counts too."</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Baked-on oven interior first, scrub montage, then the door swings open on the gleaming after as the final beat — held 2 full seconds. Optional quick fridge-shelf cutaway mid-montage.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Baked-on grease thinks time is on its side. It is not. Ovens and fridges are the deep-clean finale for a reason — is this the best reveal of the month? You tell us in the comments. Alexandria, Arlington, D.C. and Prince William. Follow for Monday transformations.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: "How often does the oven get a deep clean at your place?" Monthly / Holidays only / No comment. Save to the Before/After highlight.

TUE AUG 25 | STORY ONLY — REVIEW GRAPHIC #4

Brand-template review graphic, new review. Sticker: slider — "How much does a freshly cleaned home lower your stress?" Save to the **Reviews** highlight.

WED AUG 26 | MAID SIMPLE #4 — DWELL TIME (VOICEOVER REEL 2 OF 2)

FORMAT	Reel, 12–15 seconds with an on-screen countdown timer, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Voiceover Reel 2 of 2 (calm, professional narration recorded off-camera) over soft music. Script: "Here is a pro secret: stop wiping so soon. Spray, then give it five minutes — that is dwell time, and it is printed right on the label. Let the chemistry do the scrubbing. Maid Simple, from The Maids of Virginia."
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>"Maid Simple: stop wiping too soon"</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Spray a shower wall, timer overlay ticks forward in fast-motion while the product visibly works, then one effortless wipe reveals the clean stripe. Side text: "the label tells you the minutes."
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Maid Simple, tip #4: spray, then walk away. Every cleaner has a dwell time — the minutes it needs to sit wet and break soil down before you wipe. It is printed right on the label, and disinfectants do not disinfect without it. Spray the shower, go pour the coffee, come back to an easier job. Less scrubbing, better results. Save this one. Follow for a new pro tip every Wednesday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a question sticker: "What should Maid Simple cover next?" Answers seed the September lineup. Save to the Service highlight.
NOTES	Replaces the prior "vacuum before you mop" tip, which was below the pro-level bar for this series.

THU AUG 27 | STORY ONLY — SPOTLIGHT TEASER

Candid photo of tomorrow's featured team member mid-task (no face required if they prefer). Sticker: poll — "Tomorrow you meet one of our pros. Guess their years on the team." 2 / 5 / 8+. Save to the **Our Team** highlight.

FRI AUG 28 | TEAM SPOTLIGHT

FORMAT	Reel, 15–20 second day-in-the-life montage, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Upbeat trending audio with text overlay. No dialogue — names, years, and fun facts appear as text.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“Meet the team behind the sparkle” + name and years of service.</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Day-in-the-life montage: van load-out, the four-person team arriving, gloves on, favorite detail shots, a finished room. Overlay three text facts: name and role, years with the company, a personal favorite step of the 22. Swap in any August birthday or work anniversary as the featured moment.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	[Name] has been making Northern Virginia homes shine for [X] years. When we say referred for a reason, this is the reason. Say hi to [Name] in the comments. Follow to meet more of the team.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a slider sticker: “Show [Name] some love.” Save to the Our Team highlight.

MON AUG 31 | BEFORE/AFTER REEL — THE SEPTEMBER RESET

FORMAT	Reel, under 15 seconds. Dirty shot first in every room pair, hold the final after shot a full 2 seconds, branded cover before posting.
AUDIO	Trending back-to-school-adjacent audio or ASMR montage sound, text overlay only. No dialogue.
ON-SCREEN HOOK	<i>“School is back. Your house can reset too.”</i>
CONCEPT / SHOT PLAN	Whole-home montage, about 3 seconds per pair: entryway, kitchen, bathroom — each dirty-first, then its after. Final wide shot held 2 full seconds. Summer is the opponent here: sunscreen film, sand, snack crumbs.
CAPTION (PASTE-READY)	Labor Day week is reset week. Summer leaves its mark on every home — sunscreen, sand, snack crumbs, all of it — and one deep clean clears the board for September. Save this as your reset checklist: entryway, kitchen, bath. Alexandria, Arlington, D.C. and Prince William. Follow for transformations every Monday.
FIRST COMMENT	Standard hashtag block (page 1), posted within one minute of publishing.
STORY ACTION	Share the Reel with a poll sticker: “September reset — which room goes first?” Kitchen / Bathrooms / Entryway / All of it. Save to the Before/After highlight.

Suds and Science — Topic Bank for September and Beyond

The series is intentionally broader than product-mixing safety: any cleaning education fits. Accurate, specific, never exaggerated. Ready-to-film topics:

Next up in the series

- **Why vinegar should never touch natural stone.** Acetic acid dissolves the calcium carbonate in marble, limestone, and travertine — those dull spots are etching, not stains.
- **How HEPA filtration works.** HEPA filters capture 99.97% of particles at 0.3 microns — the hardest size to trap; larger and smaller particles are caught at even higher rates — so fine dust and allergens stay in the vacuum instead of going back into the air. A natural brand story for our HEPA-equipped teams.
- **Why microfiber lifts instead of smears.** Split fibers create thousands of tiny edges and capillary channels that pull in oil and dust, where cotton and paper mostly push them around.
- **The science of hard water.** Dissolved calcium and magnesium bond with soap into scum and stay behind as mineral film when water evaporates — why bathrooms fog and faucets crust in the same spots.

September planning inputs already built into August: the Aug 26 question sticker (“What should Maid Simple cover next?”), the Aug 6 / Aug 13 Q+A round, and the poll results from every Friday story.